tablet, they can follow along and *read you*. They can tell how quickly or slowly you turn the pages and whether you read the chapters consecutively or skip around. And they'll gladly endure looking up your nostrils and watching you move your lips as you read, so long as it gets them the data they want and lets them positively identify you.

This is the result of two decades of unchecked innovation—the final product of a political and professional class that dreams itself your master. No matter the place, no matter the time, and no matter what you do, your life has now become an open book.

★ ★ ★

IF MASS SURVEILLANCE was, by definition, a constant presence in daily life, then I wanted the dangers it posed, and the damage it had already done, to be a constant presence too. Through my disclosures to the press, I wanted to make this system known, its existence a fact that my country, and the world, could not ignore.In the years since 2013, awareness has grown, both in scope and subtlety. But in this social media age, we have always to remind ourselves: awareness alone is not enough.

In America, the initial press reports on the disclosures started a "national conversation," as President Obama himself conceded. While I appreciated the sentiment, I remember wishing that he had noted that what made it "national," what made it a "conversation," was that for the first time the American public was informed enough to have a voice.

The revelations of 2013 particularly roused Congress, both houses of which launched multiple investigations into NSA abuses. Those investigations concluded that the agency had repeatedly lied regarding the nature and efficacy of its mass surveillance programs, even to the most highly cleared Intelligence Committee legislators.

In 2015, a federal court of appeals ruled in the matter of *ACLU v. Clapper*, a suit challenging the legality of the NSA's phone records collection program. The court ruled that the NSA's program had violated even the loose standards of the Patriot Act and, moreover, was most probably unconstitutional. The ruling focused on the NSA's interpretation of Section 215 of the Patriot Act, which allowed the government to demand from third parties "any tangible thing" that it deemed "relevant" to foreign intelligence and terror investigations. In the court's opinion, the government's definition of "relevant" was so expansive as to be virtually meaningless. To call some collected data "relevant" merely because it